Day 74 - Beth Gilhespy, John Appleton, Mshkiki Miikaansing, Hawthorn

Bruce Trail side-trail plan (dog-friendly, max ~8 mi) · Peninsula section · hike 95 · Barrow Bay

10.5 km / 6.5 mi	~3.8 h	5.6 km new	200 min
total walking	hiking, plus stops	side trail covered	drive each way, Sat 7 am

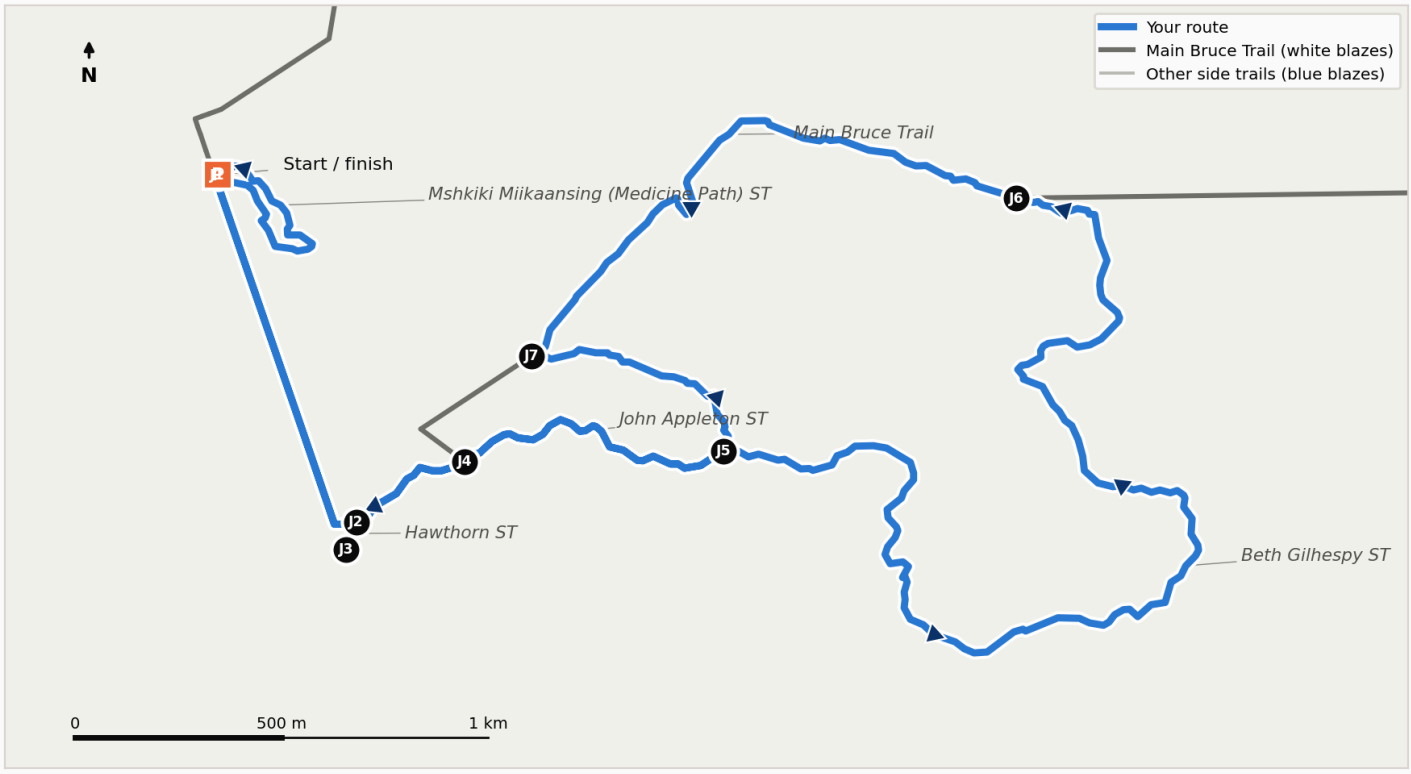
Park: Bruce Trail Parking Lot: Off of Bruce Rd 9 in Barrow Bay, just south of West Shore Rd. Google Maps.

Navigate: import *day74_hike095.gpx* into Gaia GPS. The track is the whole route in walking order, and the J waypoints match the directions below.

Side trails covered: Beth Gilhespy Side Trail (3.4 km); John Appleton Side Trail (1.4 km); Mshkiki Miikaansing (Medicine Path) Side Trail (0.7 km); Hawthorn Side Trail (0.1 km)

Route map

Day 74 | 10.5 km (6.5 mi)



What to expect

- **Parking:** Use the Bruce Trail lot off Bruce Rd 9 in Barrow Bay. The local club asks hikers not to park on the west side of Bruce Rd 9.
- **Barrow Bay Cliffs:** The main trail south of Barrow Bay runs through the Bruce Trail Conservancy's Barrow Bay Cliffs Nature Reserve (bought in 2019), a newer section that passes cliffs, lookouts and dense forest, with a staircase from the escarpment edge down to the shoreline. Keep Zappy close near the cliff edges.
- **John Appleton & Beth Gilhespy Side Trails:** The John Appleton loop passes a beaver pond and winds through hardwood forest and fractured dolostone rock on a natural, moderate surface. Watch your footing (and paws) on the cracked rock.
- **Medicine Path & Hawthorn Side Trails:** Short connectors (0.7 km and 0.1 km). No specific trail descriptions were found.
- **Road walking:** Parts of the main trail follow the shoulder of Bruce Rd 9 near Barrow Bay, at the start and end of the day. Keep Zappy on a short leash and on the outside, away from traffic.

Turn-by-turn

km	mi	Directions
0.0	0.0	Start at the parking: Bruce Trail Parking Lot: Off of Bruce Rd 9 in Barrow Bay, just south of West Shore Rd. Head south-east on the blue-blazed Mshkiki Miikaansing (Medicine Path) Side Trail.
0.7	0.4	J1: You pass the start again. Keep going on the white-blazed main Bruce Trail, heading south.
1.7	1.0	J2: Turn right onto the blue-blazed Hawthorn Side Trail, heading south. (the white-blazed main Bruce Trail goes off on your left.)

1.7	1.1	J3: End of the Hawthorn Side Trail. There is trailhead parking here (BTC Parking Area on the east side of the road; emergency #2461 Bruce County Rd 9). Turn around and retrace your steps.
1.8	1.1	J2: Continue straight onto the white-blazed main Bruce Trail, heading north-east. (the main Bruce Trail you already walked goes off on your left.)
2.1	1.3	J4: Continue straight onto the blue-blazed John Appleton Side Trail, heading north-east. (the white-blazed main Bruce Trail goes off on your left.)
2.9	1.8	J5: Turn right onto the blue-blazed Beth Gilhespy Side Trail, heading east. (the blue-blazed John Appleton Side Trail goes off on your left.)
6.2	3.9	J6: Continue straight onto the white-blazed main Bruce Trail, heading west. (the white-blazed main Bruce Trail goes off behind you.)
7.8	4.9	J7: Turn sharp left onto the blue-blazed John Appleton Side Trail, heading east. (the white-blazed main Bruce Trail goes off ahead.)
8.4	5.3	J5: Junction. Turn right to stay on the John Appleton Side Trail, heading south-west. (the Beth Gilhespy Side Trail you already walked goes off on your left.)
9.2	5.7	J4: Continue straight onto the white-blazed main Bruce Trail, heading south-west. (the white-blazed main Bruce Trail goes off on your right.)
9.5	5.9	J2: Junction. Turn right to stay on the main Bruce Trail, heading west. (the Hawthorn Side Trail you already walked goes off ahead.)
9.6	5.9	Heads-up: The next 0.9 km follows a road shoulder; keep the dog close.
10.5	6.5	Back at the parking. Hike complete.

Distances and junctions are computed from the Bruce Trail Conservancy's trail data (Bruce County GIS). Left/right is calculated from the trail geometry. Use it as a guide, follow the blazes, and check the Conservancy's trail-change notices before you go. Dogs must be leashed everywhere on the Bruce Trail. Trail descriptions draw on Bruce Peninsula Press and Ontario Nature Trails.